

CINNAMIC ALDEHYDE

_____Name
_____Date

also called...cinnamal, cinnamyl aldehyde, 3-phenyl-2-propenal, 3-phenylacrylaldehyde, or cassia aldehyde.

What is it?

The chemical cinnamic aldehyde, with its warm spicy odor and taste of cinnamon, is a common ingredient added to perfumed and flavored products.

Where might it be found?

Liquid and bar soap, cleansers
Moisturizer, cream, lotion, oil
Bath oil or gel
Make-up, concealer, powder
Mascara, eye shadow
Blush, bronzer
Lipstick, lip liner, balm, gloss
Make-up remover, toner
Shaving cream, gel, depilatory
Aftershave, cologne
Perfume, body mist
Body powder, talcum powder
Deodorant, antiperspirant
Anti-aging cream, brightener
Sunscreen, sunless tanner
Shampoo
Hair conditioner, tonic, oil
Hair gel, mousse, spray
Massage oil, aromatherapy
Surgical scrub solution
Wound care ointment
Chinese or cassia oil remedy
Medicated cream, spray
Foot powder, spray
Toothpaste, mouthwash
Dental floss, dental materials
Breath freshener, mint, candy
Chewing gum, bubble gum
Sanitary napkins, light pads
Feminine hygiene spray, rinse
Baby wipes, moistened tissues
Facial tissue, toilet paper
Dish or laundry detergent
Fabric softener
Household cleaner, deodorizer
Air freshener, potpourri sachet

Scented candles, plug-ins, incense
Cooking and baking flavorings
Waxes, polishes
Metalworking fluids, cutting oils
Corrosion inhibitors
Paints, turpentine
Insecticide, insect strips
Pet cleaner, deodorizer
Some *medications*, including inhalants
Sometimes circulated in ventilation systems

How to avoid it:

Because individual fragrance components are not usually listed on labels, you must avoid all fragranced products. Check the complete ingredient list of each product you use for fragrance or *parfum*. For products already at home that do not list ingredients, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's website, the store's website, or <http://householdproducts.nlm.nih.gov>, <http://www.cosmeticsdatabase.com>, or <http://www.drugstore.com>. Your exposure to cinnamic aldehyde may be from contact with a partner who uses fragranced products. Alert your dentist, doctor, nurse, hairdresser, masseuse, and others not to use products containing fragrance in your care.

To identify possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of all products you encounter. A small amount of fragrance may be present even though *not* listed. You may need to contact the manufacturer to learn if fragrance is present. Choose fragrance-free alternatives, or wear rubber or vinyl gloves.

(continued)

Additional information:

Cinnamic aldehyde is found in cinnamon leaves, cinnamon bark, and essential oils of hyacinth, myrrh, patchouli, and Bulgarian rose. It is a major ingredient of cassia, also called Chinese cinnamon. It is also present in Ceylon cinnamon, balsam of Peru, and balsam of Tolu.

You may react to cinnamic *alcohol* and cinnamic *acid* also, because in the skin they are converted into cinnamic aldehyde.

Occasionally you may find that cinnamic aldehyde in a product does *not* produce a reaction. This may happen when sufficient eugenol or *d*-limonene is also present.

If there is a particular perfumed product you must use, ask your doctor how you can perform a repeated open application test (ROAT). You may wish to do a ROAT with products first before buying.

What about food?

It is uncommon for a *generalized dermatitis* to occur from ingesting foods and beverages containing cinnamic aldehyde. It is more common for hand dermatitis to occur in bakers who handle spices. Still, it is a good idea to use caution and watch for worsening if you ingest the following:

- cola beverages
- cinnamon-flavored coffee
- vermouth
- bitters
- chocolate
- ice cream
- chewing gum
- candy
- spices